

TO: Members of the State Board of Education

FROM: Carey M. Wright, Ed.D., State Superintendent of Schools

DATE: December 9, 2025

SUBJECT: Teacher Workforce Update



Purpose

The purpose of this item is to provide an update on beginning-of-year teacher vacancies and the number of conditionally licensed positions, as well as to present an overview of statewide recruitment initiatives.

Executive Summary

Local education agencies are required to report staff data on an annual basis. The most recent data collection includes beginning-of-year vacancies and staff on the payroll actively assigned as of October 15, 2025. The presentation includes an update of the conditionally licensed teacher workforce and recruitment initiatives aimed at diversifying and increasing the number of high-quality teachers across the state.

Action

No action is required; this information is for discussion only.

Attachment

Teacher Workforce Update

Division of Educator Effectiveness

Teacher Workforce Update

December 9, 2025

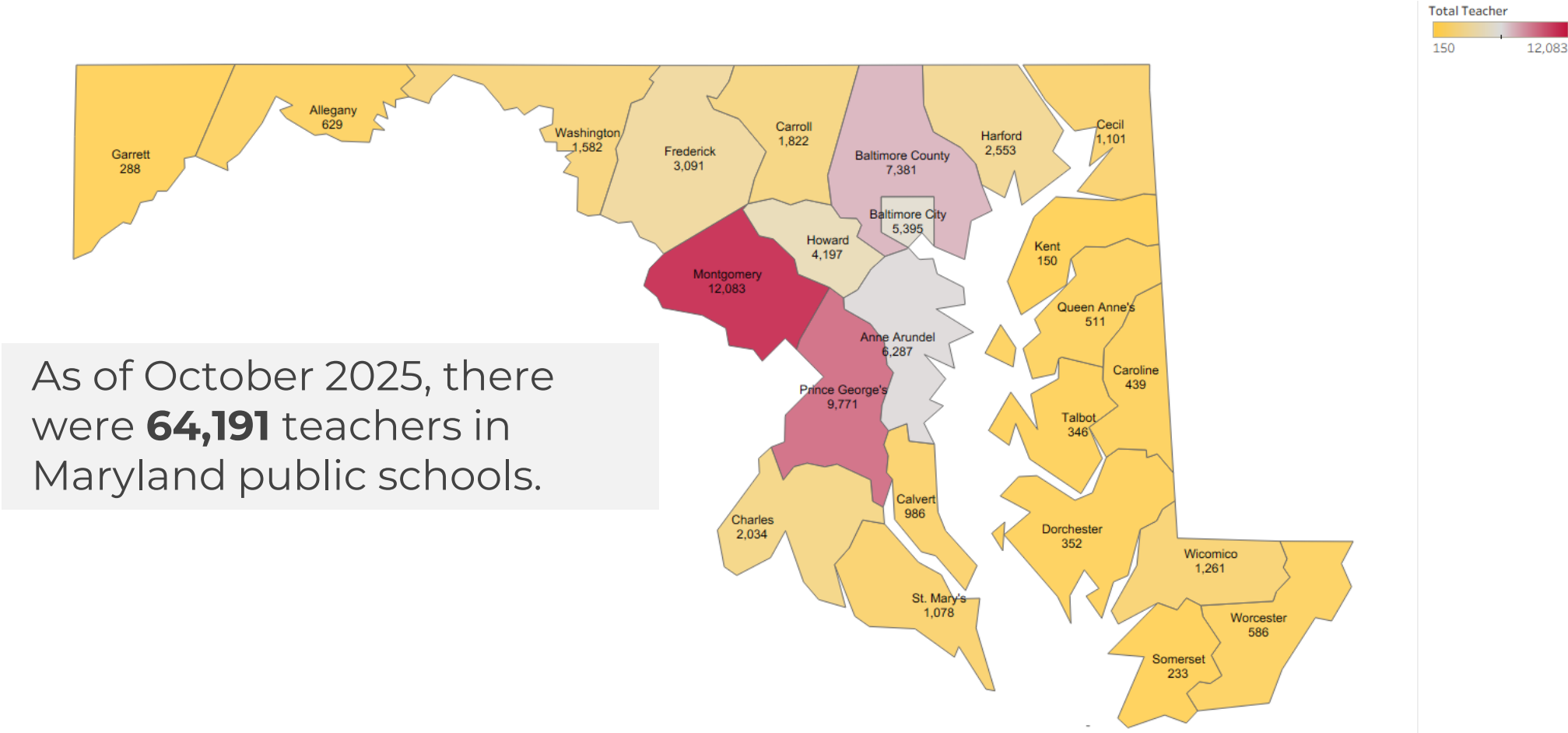
Presented By | Kelly Meadows, Assistant State Superintendent, Division of Educator Effectiveness

A photograph of a smiling teacher with curly blonde hair giving a high-five to a young student with curly dark hair wearing a yellow and black striped shirt. They are in a classroom with other students in the background.

Presentation Outline

1. Workforce Overview
2. Teacher Vacancies
3. Conditionally Licensed Teachers
4. State-Level Recruitment Initiatives

Maryland Teacher Workforce, SY 2025-2026

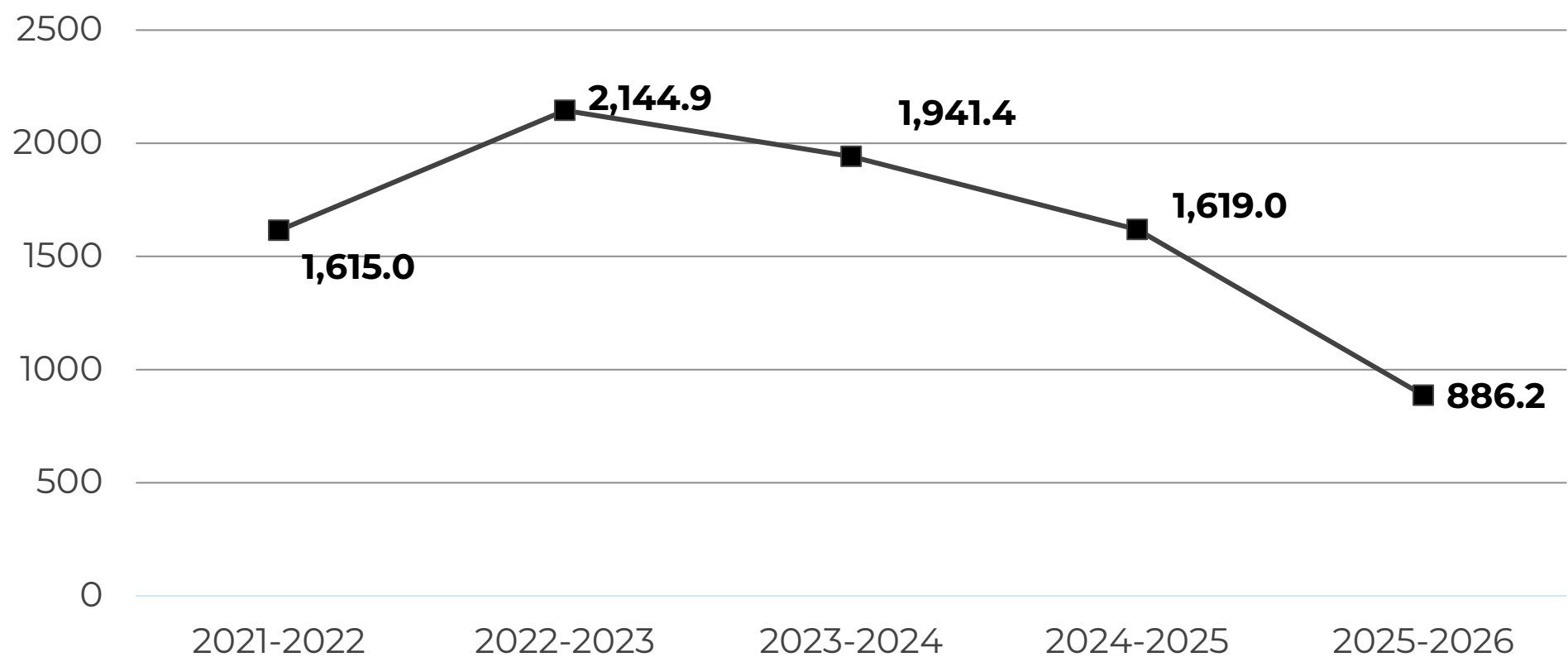


Source: MSDE Staff Data Collection

Note: The total number of teachers includes 35 teachers in The SEED School, which is not included in any LEA counts. Only teachers whose primary role is teaching are included in the total count.

Teacher Vacancies

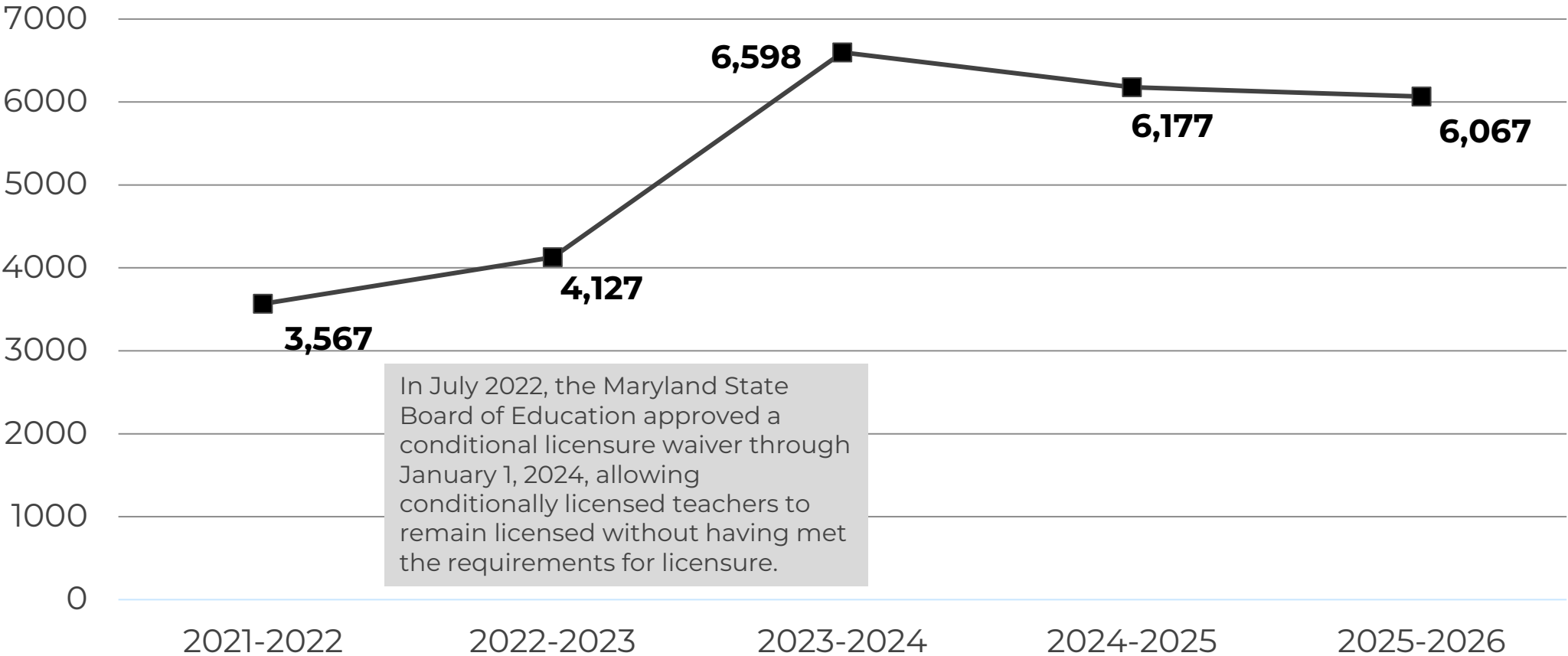
Teacher vacancies decreased by 45.3% in 2025-2026 from the previous year. Special education vacancies decreased by 21.4% and elementary education vacancies decreased by 63.3%.



Source: MSDE Annual Vacancy Data Collection

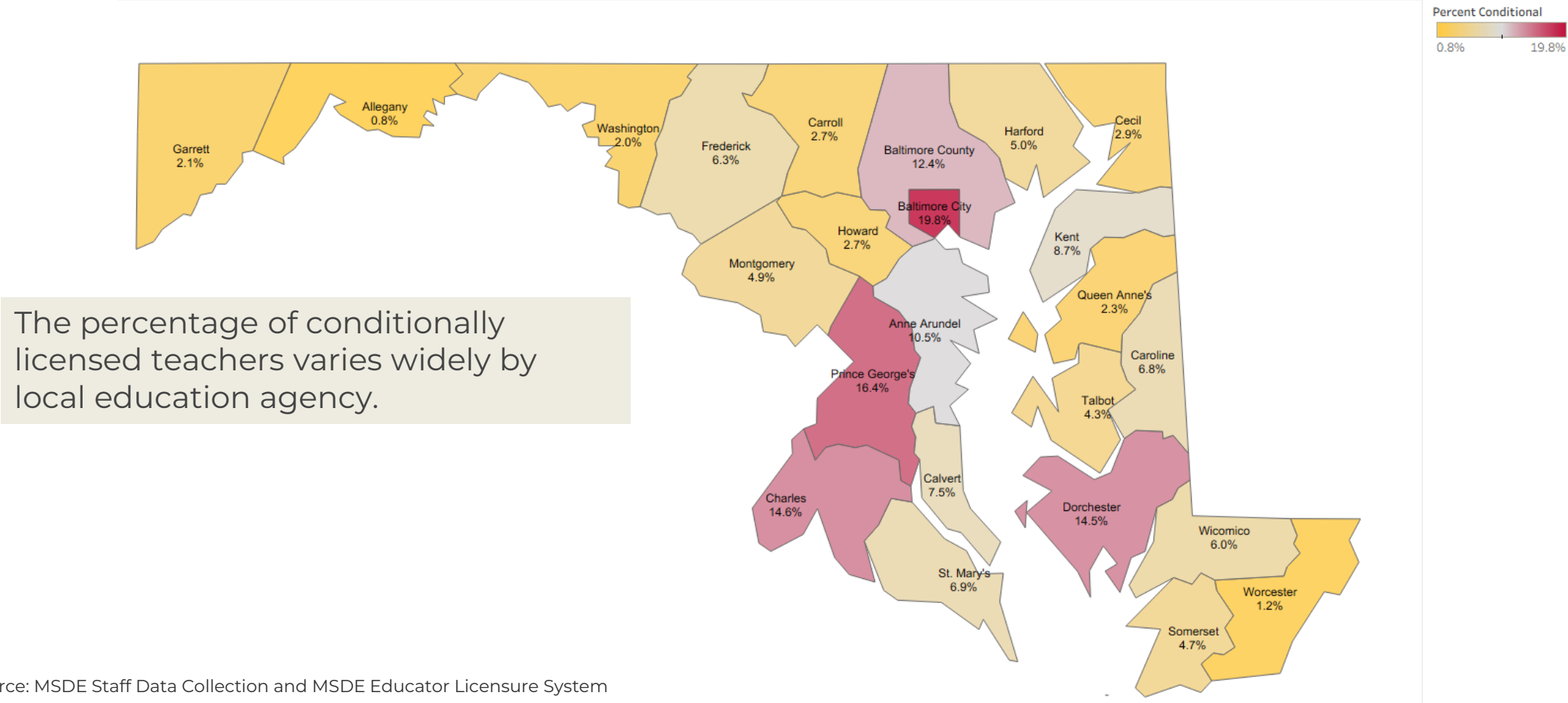
Maryland Conditional Licensure Trends

The number of conditionally licensed teachers has slowly decreased over the past two years.



Source: MSDE Staff Data Collection and MSDE Educator Licensure System.

Conditionally Licensed Teachers as Percent of LEA Workforce – Fall 2025

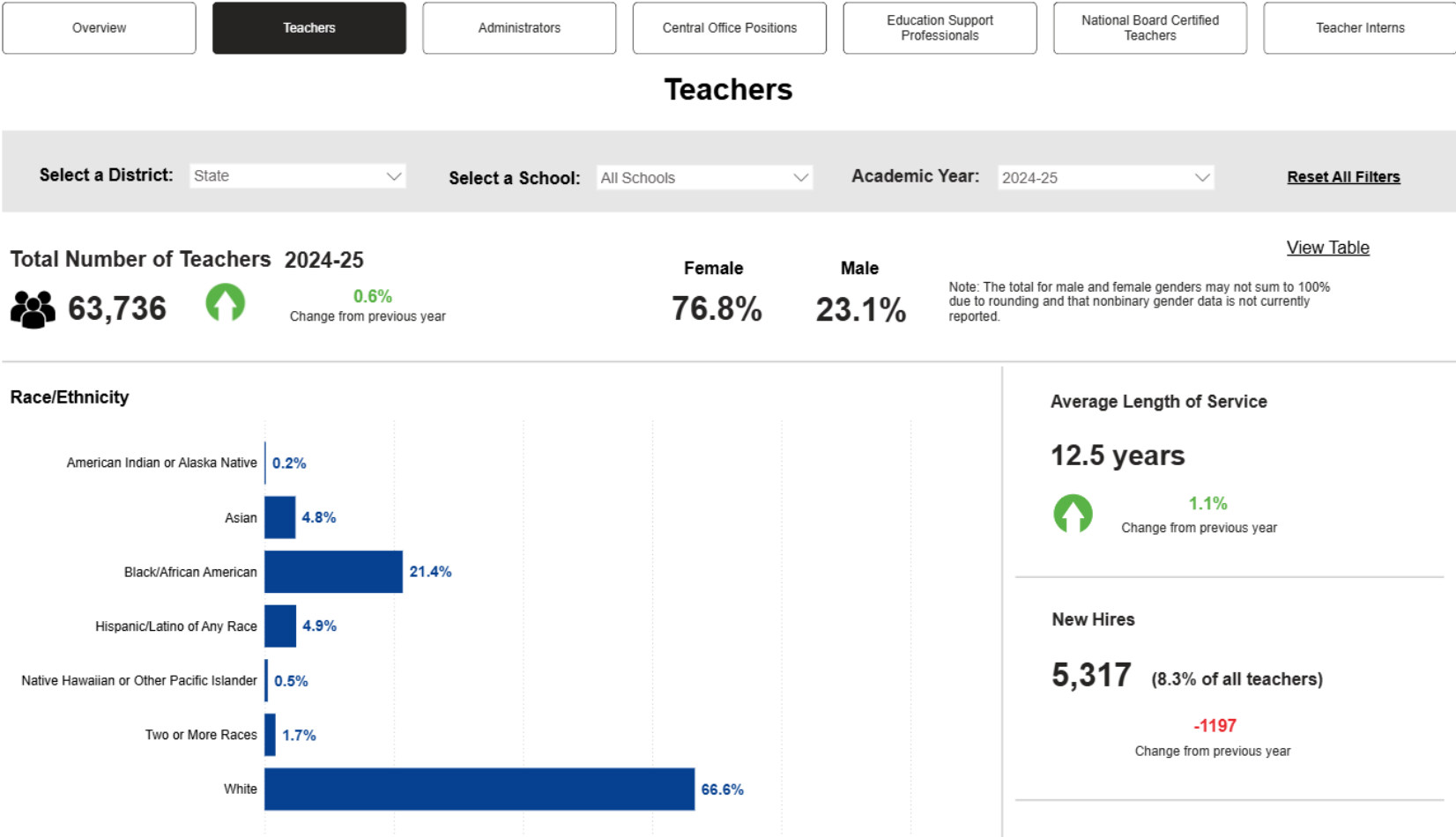


Source: MSDE Staff Data Collection and MSDE Educator Licensure System

The total conditional count by LEA was divided by the total LEA teacher count to get the share of the workforce calculation.

Maryland Educator Workforce Dashboard

- Established in 2024
- Updated annually
- Displays demographics and data
 - Teachers
 - Administrators
 - central office positions
 - education support professionals
 - NBCTs
 - student teachers across Maryland



Source: <https://marylandpublicschools.org/about/Pages/DEE/educator-dashboard.aspx>

Teach Maryland: National Recruitment Campaign and Outreach Program



Marketing Campaign

Teach Maryland utilizes a combination of digital and print advertising, social media posts, radio spots, posters, flyers, bus wraps, bus shelter advertisements, digital billboards, and streaming services as a platform for the recruitment of a diverse pool of potential teachers.

Outreach Program

MSDE hosts an annual Teach Maryland conference for high school students, including those enrolled in the Teacher Academy of Maryland

National Recruitment

MSDE will partner with a national education nonprofit to provide:

- 1:1 mentoring support
- Public service announcement advertising
- Digital marketing
- Direct outreach to prospective candidates

Relocation Incentive Grant



Source: [MD Code, Education Article §6-131](#)

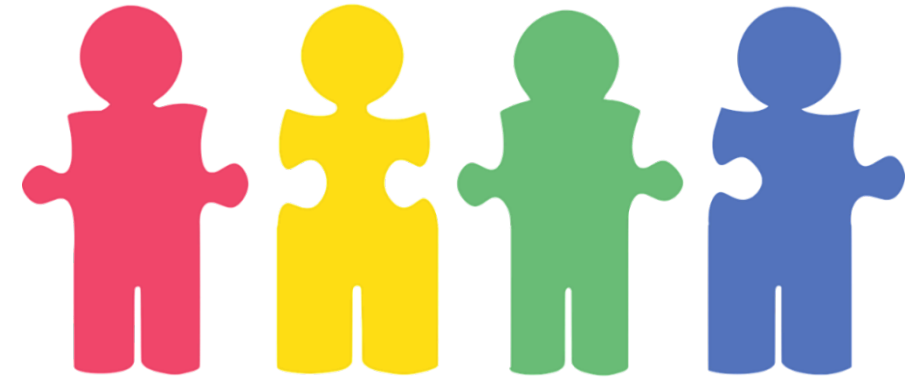
Grow Your Own Grant Program

- Provides support to collaboratives of local education agencies/local unions/institutions of education that offer teacher licensure programs with on-the-job experiential learning for individuals who:
 - Are interested in pursuing a career in the teaching profession
 - Are employed by a local education agency in the State as a school-based part-time or full-time employee
 - Pledge to fulfill a 3-year service obligation as a teacher employed full-time in a high-needs school, grade level, or content area
- Funds can be used for:
 - Tuition, books, and fees for teacher candidates
 - Stipends for mentor teachers
 - Costs associated with the administration of the Program
- GYO Educator Grant Program application window will open during the winter of the 2025-2026 school year
- Total Grant Amount: \$19.4 million

Source: [Education Article, §18-27A-04](#)

MSDE's Registered Teacher Apprenticeship Program (RTAP)

- Approved by the Joint Apprenticeship and Training Council in September 2025
- Developed in partnership with MD Labor and the Maryland State Education Association
- Earn as you learn, competency-based program
- Aimed at a range of potential participants
 - HS students considering teaching
 - Education support professionals
 - Mid-career professionals seeking a career change into education
- Apprentice completes coursework through a Maryland-approved teacher preparation program employed and learning from a professionally licensed teacher
- First cohorts expected to start in 2026 in Caroline and Washington Counties



Alternative Pathways to Teacher Licensure

- The State Board of Education and Professional Standards Board are promulgating regulations that expand the pathways to teacher licensure
 - Fine Arts Transcript Analysis for licensure in art, music, dance, and theater
 - Secondary Content Transcript Analysis for licensure in content areas with 7 – 12 grade bands

